

More waste separated, but how much recycled?

A public claim, tested against Eurostat, NSO and EU targets

THE CLAIM

“Malta continues to make strong progress in waste management.”

Ministry for the Environment, press release PR260072en, 19 January 2026

Minister Dalli: the waste plan “is working”; 412 million kg diverted from landfill in five years.

EU targets are measured on waste actually recycled after sorting, not on kilograms separated.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Separation is up;
the outcome isn’t shown.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

Rising

Separation is up

NSO confirms more organic, grey-bag, glass and deposit-scheme waste. Landfilled municipal waste fell 21% since 2019.

16.7%

Actually recycled, 2024

Share of municipal waste recycled. EU average 48%. The 2025 target is 55%.

79%

Still landfilled

Of treated municipal waste in 2024. The 2020 target was missed by a wide margin.

412 vs 271

Thousand tonnes

Ministry’s “diverted” figure vs Eurostat’s recycled or recovered waste, 2020–24.

No year

For “141 to 95.5 million kg”

The mixed-waste fall of 32% has no start year and is not a published statistic.

FAIR TO SAY

Mandatory separation, organic collection and gate fees are measures that research links to higher recycling. The direction is right; the claim is about how far it has got.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Scope, years and method behind 412 million kg.

☐ How much separated waste is rejected and landfilled.

☐ Why no composting or digestion is reported as recycling.

☐ The year Malta expects to reach 55% recycled.